

LS Electric (010120.KS): 2026 Investor Day takeaway: Management constructive on AI DC electric equipment demand; executing on the

We attended LS Electric 2026 Investor Day hosted by the Chairman alongside senior business division heads, where the company outlined strategic milestones across US data center penetration, DC power architecture, mid-term Capex, and its competitive moats.

Bottom line: Management highlighted direct-current (DC) as the key architecture underpinning future power infrastructure and remained positive on the secular growth trend tied to US AI data center demand. The company believes it is well-positioned to adapt to potential shifts associated with NVIDIA's 800V DC ecosystem, leveraging its early establishment of a fully DC-powered facility in Cheonan. Against this backdrop, LSE is accelerating capacity expansion across major product categories to capture the growth opportunities.

Key Takeaways:

■ **Secular structural transition driven by AI DC & grid decentralization:** The Chairman emphasized that current market dynamics represent a structural transition anchored by three intertwined pillars: (i) explosive power demand from AI data centers and electrification, (ii) a shift toward decentralized/onsite generation (microgrids, renewables, SMRs, fuel cells), and (iii) direct-current (DC) power technology. Global tech capex is projected to reach US\$6.7tn cumulatively through 2030, with a substantial portion deployed directly into electrical infrastructure per company estimates. While power generation and transmission remain dominated by the Big 3 global players (77% market share in HVDC/FACTS), management believes distribution solutions and behind-the-meter (BTM) applications represent an addressable market exceeding US\$89bn. Management highlighted that LSE is aggressively targeting this space by leveraging its integrated portfolio across generation, transmission, and intelligent distribution.

■ **US market outlook:** Following early US market headwinds in EV battery plant projects (orders fell from c.US\$240mn in 2023 to c.US\$60mn in 2024), LSE achieved an inflection point in 2024 by securing power distribution switchgear for a hyperscaler 1.2GW landmark data center after competitors failed to meet lead-time targets. Cumulative orders from the same customer have surpassed W1tn across 2025–2026, boosting the company's industry track record and positioning LSE for another major mega-project win before year-end. US distribution system sales grew 91% YoY, operating at an unprecedented book-to-bill ratio of 3.16x (vs. a major competitor at early-1x). Importantly, customer acquisition has transformed into a

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recurring business opportunity: 66% of order volume comes from repeat buyers, and 85% is contracted via direct procurement rather than traditional distributors. In 2027, management forecasts BTM sales to more than double YoY, with tier-1 recurring hyperscaler accounts expanding from 6 to 8 (including active talks with a frontier LLM developer). Furthermore, price hikes across core medium-voltage (MV) switchgear are expected to lift margins onwards.

■ **800V DC strategy:** Management identified direct current as the core architecture of future power infrastructure, delivering up to 20% savings in power conversion loss alongside superior network firewalls and fault recovery. As compute rack density surpasses 600kW—rendering traditional AC distribution obsolete—the hyperscaler ecosystem (led by Nvidia's Vera Rubin Ultra and Feynman architectures alongside OCP standards) is to pivot to native 800VDC distribution from 2028 onward per company estimates. LSE has established first-mover infrastructure by operating the world's first 100% DC-powered manufacturing facility in Cheonan (incorporating solid-state transformers (SST), solid-state circuit breakers (SSCB), and DC ESS), co-developing official national DC grid standards with KEPCO.

■ **Capacity outlook:** To satisfy hyperscalers' emerging electric equipment demand, LSE is scaling manufacturing capacity by more than 3x through 2030:

- **Electric equipment:** Base production capacity will expand 3x by 2030, supported by dedicated production lines at Cheongju for Big Tech bespoke orders. Production of high-demand 38kV medium-voltage circuit breakers has expanded 10-fold from 150 units/month last year to 1,500 units/month by end-2026.

- **Switchgear:** The Utah MCM Engineering facility (16-acre expansion) is slated for a mid-2027 expansion, pairing with expanded Cheongju plants and flexible Korean subcontractor networks to grow overall switchgear capacity from W1.3tn at year-end 2025 to over W3.9tn by 2030. Workforce bottlenecks in Utah are being mitigated through local university partnerships and sending US technicians to Cheongju for automation training.

- **High-Voltage Transformers:** Capacity scaled from W200bn in 2025 to W700bn, with further expansions under review across subsidiaries to alleviate sold-out backlogs.

■ **Competitive moats and financial structure:** Management rejected market concerns that peer capacity expansion will erode LSE's competitive advantages, citing that lead-time is only a part of its value propositions. In management's view, legacy incumbents have historically neglected flexible customer engineering and custom specifications, creating an opening for LSE to capture M/S through agility, integrated testing facilities, and comprehensive UL certifications (which maintain a 2+ year barrier over domestic followers). Furthermore, tightened US executive orders restricting Chinese electrical equipment on national security grounds provide durable market insulation, particularly in high-spec ESS and distribution. On financial structure, adjusted debt-to-equity stands at a manageable ~130% (excluding customer advance deposits). In parallel with active non-core asset sales (such as the recent divestment of the rail signaling unit), management is diversifying its capital sourcing beyond domestic corporate bonds toward global funding structures.

We are Neutral rated. Our 12-month target price of W230,000 is based on a mid-cycle target PE multiple of 31.0x applied to 2028 EPS.

Downside risks: 1) New order momentum waning, 2) Delays or slower ramp-up US AIDC build outs, 3) Fast adoption of orbital data centers could impact LSE's distribution related business outlook beyond 2030.

Upside risks: 1) Faster and/or larger AI DC customer pool expansion, 2) Faster recurring electric equipment revenue realization in the US, which enjoys 2x margins vs. domestic margins, 3) Slow adoption of disruptive technologies such as orbital DC and hence a higher-for-longer DC-related new order momentum.

010120.KS12m Price Target: **W230,000**Price: **W206,000**Upside: **11.7%****Neutral****GS Forecast**

		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Market cap: W30.9tr / \$23.1bn	Revenue (W bn)	4,965.8	6,263.9	8,023.5	9,892.6
Enterprise value:	EBITDA (W bn)	558.7	911.4	1,321.2	1,824.3
W31.5tr / \$23.5bn	EPS (W)	1,911	3,257	5,163	7,531
3m ADTV: W190.2bn / \$128.7mn	P/E (X)	30.5	63.2	39.9	27.4
South Korea	P/B (X)	4.2	12.8	10.1	7.8
Korea Autos & Industrials	Dividend yield (%)	1.0	0.5	0.7	1.1
M&A Rank: 3	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	0.8	0.5	0.3	0.0
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?:	CROCI (%)	8.8	14.2	17.5	21.7
Yes	FCF yield (%)	1.1	0.2	0.6	1.8
		6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
	EPS (W)	790	787	877	1,122

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 10 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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LS Electric (010120.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
27-Aug-26	230,000	219,500

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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